

# OREGON CITY COURIER

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## A GREAT VICTORY

Last week the greatest victory since the outbreak of the terrible war in Europe was recounted in the press of the world. And strange to relate, though part of the news of this victory came from Paris, the armed capital of France, there was not a line in the dispatches about the number of killed or wounded or captured. In fact there were no killed, wounded or captured. The victory was bloodless; but its importance to the world will be greater than any victory of a military order, that may occur in the progress of them ad-slaughterfest in Europe.

The victory to which the Courier thus refers was the culmination of the long battle waged by electricians and scientists to transmit the voice by wireless from one world continent to another. The victory was won when a man sitting in the United States Naval wireless station at Arlington spoke to men at the receiving end of a wireless plant on the Eiffel tower in Paris. The victory for mankind came when six words leaped across the intervening Atlantic ocean, and when the United States, for the first time, actually spoke to France with the human voice.

Such an accomplishment is far greater than anything that may come of the European conflict. It means more to the human race, to its progress and development, to the knitting together of men of all nations into one great family. And it is particularly appropriate that the first message from the new world to the old should have been spoken between America and France—the two great sister republics of the world. The history of the United States shows that since the very beginning France has been the sincere friend of this country. In the War of Independence it was French aid that freed the colonies from the yoke of England, in the Civil War it was France that showed her friendship for our republic by frowning upon the efforts of England in particular to aid the Confederate cause. The United States has gained much in every way from France; our art, our science and our letters have been largely influenced by French leadership; and our proud Statue of Liberty Enlightening the World is a gift of France.

Hence it is, in every way that the first wireless telephonic communication between this country and the old world should have been with France. It is true that the fact that an American voice carried to the Eiffel tower does not make the victory any greater than it would have been had communication been established with some other country; yet it is pleasing to know that the first vocal message to leap across the ocean from one hemisphere to the other leaped from one republic to another as notable.

And while the conversation with France broke one record—that of transmitting the human voice from the new world to the old—it is also pleasing to Americans to know that the great victory of this kind was the leap of the human voice from Arlington to Honolulu—thus spanning the greatest distance entirely between American points. These two victories, dual as they are, proclaim much for American science and progress; and coming at this time of war and death on one side of the world, convey a promise of coming peace and plenty as it now prevails on the other side of the world. Histories in the future will clearly show that while war was a victory of peace—a victory in which the kill of men was used to better human conditions, instead of being used to destroy life. The call of the voice from America to France is a call from the new world to the old world, a call for the old world to drop its barbarism and its retrograding, and to turn its face anew to progress and to humanity's cause.

## SIGNS OF THE TIMES

Are we a progressive community? Surely we are, is the answer. People right now in the county seat are pointing with pride to the fact that Oregon City has pure mountain water, a well-paved Main street, and an elevator that appears at this writing to be nearing readiness to operate. This is great stuff in the progress line people tell us.

It is. But there are other things to be considered. For instance, about half a year ago a man driving a Ford automobile—of course it had to be a Ford—ran into a post at the eastern end of the county suspension bridge across the Willamette river, and knocked the post over. On the post was a sign—a Pacific Highway sign. That sign told the traveler which direction to take to follow the main road; it was a great aid to the traveler; it was a mark of goodwill. The sign was placed by the Pacific Highway organization, and was one of thousands placed along the coast from the Canadian border to the Mexican line. It was a real "sign of the times."

The automobile, in demolishing the post, temporarily removed this sign. In due course of time employees of the county came along, gathered up the wreck of the broken post, filled up the hole that the post had formerly occupied, and cleared up the wreckage. The Pacific Highway sign was taken from the post and thrown under the suspension bridge—and there it has been ever since—out of sight and useless, but still, in another way, a "sign of the times."

Lying in the dirt under the bridge, out of use as a guiding hand held up to strangers in the community, this neglected "sign of the times" is a silent indictment of the "progress of this community. It is just as much a sign of "progress" as is the elevator, the paved street, or the pure mountain water, all of which are to be found within a few feet of the neglected highway pointer. This neglected sign, if it could speak, would shout out that Oregon City and the county court of Clackamas county are both heedlessly selfish. They glory in improvements that have cost thousands, but they forget the little sign that cost them nothing, but which made the way of the stranger easier.

To have put another post in the place of the one that was broken would have cost no more labor than was expended tearing the old, broken post out, and in throwing the sign away. To have nailed the sign upon the new post would have cost probably four nails. It is likely that a nearby merchant, had he been asked, would have donated these nails. But apparently NOBODY THOUGHT OF THAT. And that is what is the matter with these times of ours—people do not think of the little things in life—and it is the little things, like this sign, that really point out the degree of progress in human fraternity that is being made.

Many towns in this county have recently started campaigns to place signs upon the roadways leading to them, telling the traveler the way to go. This has been done for the selfish motive that people seeing these signs will go to the towns thusly advertised, and will trade there. But at that such signs are steps in the right direction. Oregon City, to date, hasn't even put up any signs telling people how to get to it. And Oregon City, to date, is still willing that this Pacific Highway sign should lie hidden under the bridge. Oregon City apparently doesn't care enough for the comfort of the passing stranger to even direct him on his road. And when a community or a county cares as little about strangers as all that, it is hardly the time to gloat over pure mountain water, elevators and paved streets.

## BOYS AND BRASS BUTTONS

Portland and other Oregon communities have lately been considerably wrought up over the proposal to establish military training in the public schools. People have declared that they didn't bring up their boys to be soldiers; that military training was not the outgrowth of a popular demand, but was the insidious attack on childhood of the war trust; that it was un-American. And in spite of all this, Portland has finally decided to adopt military training in its schools if certain conditions as to upkeep and time can be met.

The Courier holds no brief either for mollycoddles or for military en-

thusiasts. As far as boys and girls are concerned, this paper is chiefly concerned in seeing them grow up into better men and women than we have with us at present—and this casts no reflection on the present generation. But if we can't make our children better than we have been, we are pretty poor people. Each generation should be an improvement upon the former one, and American history has shown that each generation usually is better than the one that went before.

And from this viewpoint the Courier thinks that any school board may well adopt military training in its upper grade of schools. Military training as it is had in progressive cities and schools is nothing more or less than a method of teaching boys to improve their bodily physique, of teaching them obedience to rules that will benefit the majority, and of teaching them order in their duties. Military training will not make any normal boy want to be a soldier—in fact most boys who have military training during their high school years are clear of the militia unless there is an imperative call to arms. And then, because of their training, they are better fitted to take up the defense of their country.

Massachusetts, which is the hotbed of anti-imperialism, and which is the native home of the leaders in the nation-wide movement against militarism, has had for years training in its high schools. And the boys who have had the advantage of this training have been better and more useful citizens than those who have not. The "setting up exercises" have given them broader chests and deeper lungs, the manual of arms has taught them how to make their muscles work in unison, and the obedience of orders

of logic came from Mr. Sullivan's lips when the Honorable Christian Schuebel told him that he could not run Oregon City on a seven-mill levy, as is proposed in a charter amendment.

Mr. Sullivan took pencil and paper, and let Mr. Schuebel call off the necessary expenditures for the city—not the frills, but the imperatively needed things—and when he got through figuring it developed that a seven-mill levy would not only pay the expenses of the city, but that some \$3,000 was left over for emergencies. Mr. Schuebel appeared to be quite surprised to discover this, and Councilman Templeton had his doubts about it even after Mr. Schuebel accepted the logic.

Most people know that it is quite possible to live within one's income, whether the income be a dollar a day or a dollar a minute. With the small income certain things have to be left out. Any man can live right up to the limit of his income; just as any city can do it. And in figuring the budget for next year Oregon City started in by saying that it would levy a ten-mill tax—and then proceeded to frame a budget that will stretch this ten mills to the limit.

Mr. Sullivan's statement that the way to manage city affairs was to see how little need be spent, instead of how a definite sum fixed in advance could be spent, should be taken to heart by the city fathers. If, as was shown, Oregon City can worry through the next year on a seven-mill levy for actual municipal expenses, it is not very flattering to the council to have history record that they determined on a ten-mill levy. Between the two there is a three-mill tax on the already heavily burdened property-owners; and every council-

ord he and his committee had made. The Courier in its offer even pointed out to Mr. Templeton that this valued publicity would be given him without support.

Up to the time at which this is being written Mr. Templeton has not favored the Courier with any report of the details of the street expenditures during the past year, nor has he intimated that he would be glad to avail himself of this free publicity. Inasmuch as Mr. Templeton has been attacked from various quarters, and has been charged with squandering the street money recklessly; and inasmuch as in his brief report to the city council he had to laboriously explain that figures that appeared to show an excess over the budget allowance of some \$4,000 really showed a surplus of \$3,000, the Courier is surprised at Mr. Templeton's silence.

Can it be that "Oregon City's only honest councilman" does not care to make public a detailed report of the street committee's expenditures for the year? And if so, why does Mr. Templeton desire to cover up the outlay under glittering generalities, which show an expenditure of some \$14,000, yet are supposed to leave a surplus on hand out of approximately \$10,000 of \$3,000? The Courier is quite curious about this—in fact it is not alone in its curiosity, if what taxpayers tell us is true. There are a lot of people who hoped Mr. Templeton would take advantage of the Courier's offer; and show in cold type just what the street committee did with all its money.

Mr. Templeton has requested that there be placed upon the ballot at the coming city election an amendment to the city charter which will do away with the publishing of city notices. Mr. Templeton says this amendment

much to dispel the opinion in some minds that he opposes the measure because it did not become a law through his particular channel.—(Hubbard Enterprise)

Again we remark, do your Christmas shopping early—and do it at our home stores.

Little drops of water, commonly called rain, make the tax-tired farmer, shout "good roads" again.

New Jersey turned down woman suffrage. Anybody who has ever been there can understand why.

How little we hear of William Jennings Bryan these days. Apparently the Courier guessed right when it said the American people hated a man who "quit cold."

William Sumner Bird's "progressive" paper in Boston has flopped over to the old republican party. Teddy may now be expected to give his opinion of yet another person.

Fining a councilman \$500 for exceeding the budget, and making him pay the excess is a good idea, and should carry weight with the voters when they consider the budget amendment in December.

The Journal's reply to the Telegram's attack on its "greased wire service" was unique, at least. The Journal said that if its news was phony it could not see why a competitor should weep. There's logic in that—but no answer to the original charge.

"After a woman has raised a son to the age when he begins to notice things, she should take a reef in her flirtations," remarks the Houlton Herald. A woman who raises a son or a daughter has no business to be flirtatious at any stage of the game.

We noticed some republican paper the other day that explained how Hughes was more valuable on the supreme bench than as a candidate to defeat Wilson. Of a verity, brother, a job in the hand is worth more than two in the hands of the electorate.

It is nice to have the power of any municipality tested in court. Take, for instance, the arrest of an evangelist in the county seat recently for disturbing the peace. There is nothing like a case of this nature to show just how far the police powers of a city can go.

"It is a fundamental rule of law that the motives of any legislative body cannot be questioned in court," said an attorney arguing in the jury proceedings in the county seat last week. This is a very fortunate fact for some Oregon City councilmen—who have not even tried to hide their motives in opposing the jitney.

Many people have asked the Courier for the name of the author of "The Song of the Pure Water God," published in our last issue. The prose poem has made a deep impression, and it was the Courier's fault that the name of the author was omitted when the work was published. Thomas A. Burke, of Gladstone, was the writer who caught the popular feeling and expressed it so well in words.

## SORROW IS GENERAL

Death of Joseph Bachman, Jr., Casts Gloom Over Clackamas District

Regret at the recent sudden and unexpected death of Joseph Bachman, Jr. is general throughout the territory centering about Clackamas station, and many families have been saddened by the popular young man's untimely end. Mr. Bachman was laid at rest in Damascus cemetery on Tuesday of last week, and one of the largest funeral corteges ever seen in this section followed the body to the grave. There were over a hundred carriages and vehicles in the procession of mourners, and after the final rites had been pronounced over the young man's remains, floral tributes completely covered his final resting place.

The funeral sermon was preached by the Rev. Dr. Landsborough, of the Presbyterian church in the county seat and a special choir rendered music during the ceremony. Pall-bearers who carried the casket bearing the remains of Mr. Bachman were Roy Otty, Melville Byers, Christ Swenson, Carl Rathel, Arthur Varphal and Emil Lehman.

Young Mr. Bachman came to his death as the result of after-effects of an operation, in which his arm was removed, following wounds resulting from the unexpected discharge of a shotgun while he was cleaning it. The young man was a patient at the Oregon City hospital for the operation and appeared to be rallying successfully when death came suddenly on October 16.

Mr. Bachman was born at Aurora, February 9 1891, the eldest son of Joseph and Bertha Bachman. When two years of age he moved with his parents and family to Brookside farm, three miles east of Clackamas. He was a graduate of the Stone public school; and for the last several years had been in complete charge of his father's farm, making it rank as one of the best in the lower Clackamas valley. He was a general favorite with both young and old people among his neighbors, and was in great demand at all parties and other gatherings of the neighborhood.

Besides his parents, he is survived by one brother, George Bachman; and by his sisters, the Misses Anna, Emma, Jessie, Laura and Jennie Bachman, and Mrs. Lee and Mrs. Larsen, of Portland.

## HOW ABOUT IT, BILLY?

Three Burglaries, and Sheriff Didn't Tell County Seat Papers

The Southern Pacific depot at this place was broken into last Friday

## TROUBLES OF THE PRESS

Publicity Man of German Health Resort Gets Off Something Good

Publicity as a fine art was developed in these United States. After the press agent in this country began to show results, enterprising concerns in the old world copied American methods, and commenced to tell the public what they had to offer, more or less along the American press-agent methods. And in course of time the press-agent habit got to Kreuznach Baths, a German health resort that is making quite a bid for American patronage.

The gay and festive press agent at "Bad Kreuznach," as it is spelled in German, may have done a very excellent job in the native tongue of the Fatherland, but when he came to translating his dope into English, so that American doctors might be informed of the advantages of the resort, he began to pile up troubles for himself. A copy of a booklet devoted to extolling the virtues of Kreuznach has recently fallen into the hands of the Courier, and on opening it to page 3 we find in large letters:

KREUZNACH CURES INTELLIGENCE

This gave us quite a start until we reasoned it out. After we had done that we felt sorry for the poor press agent who was trying to tell Americans about the place he was boosting. What he meant to say was "Information about the Kreuznach System." He probably got hold of a dictionary that told him the meaning of the word "intelligence" was "information, advice, news, comprehensive understanding." And he naturally calls his particular health system the "Kreuznach Cure." When you understand that, it is easy to see what he means when he proclaims that "Kreuznach Cures Intelligence."

Some of the things that Kreuznach has to offer are listed as follows by this press agent who is struggling with a strange language:

"Roman-Irish vapour baths," "Great Graduation Works," "Walks for Earth cure," and "new Radium Inhalatorium."

Among the things that the Kreuznach cure is said to benefit we find a new one—according to the press-agent, the waters of Kreuznach Baths are good for "corned eyelids."

## CHANCE FOR BOOM

Oil Reported Struck at Moderate Depth Near Canby

While drilling for an artesian well on his place three miles south of Canby, G. E. Potratz recently struck oil in such quantity as to cause considerable excitement. When the drill was down about 500 feet the oil was struck and came to the surface. Mr. Potratz was much surprised when a match was applied to the fluid to see a string of fire spread over the ground.

The oil is reported to be of very fair quality and indications point to the fact that if the well is sunk to sufficient depth a quantity and quality of oil would undoubtedly be obtained that would create something of a furor in the "oil world." A number of people have examined it, including one oil expert who expressed it as his opinion that the whole Mackburg valley may be underlaid with oil, and if this should prove to be the case would become a great oil producing section.—(Canby Herald)

night and the contents therein noted. The thieves broke a window and entered the office. They could find no money and so contented themselves with carrying off a suit case and a bunch of keys. The same night the depot at Barlow was entered, but the provokers found the till open and empty as the agent had left it, which rather discouraged them and they left without molesting things further.

On Sunday night the depot at Milwaukie was also entered, and likewise here the intruders could find no money. The would-be-thieves seemed to have tough luck in all three cases and doubtless have concluded that the S. P. is getting hard up.—(Canby Herald)

We take particular pains with the stationery we print for our customers.

## MRS. SLACK'S LETTER

To Mothers of Delicate Children

Palmyra, Pa.—"My little girl had a chronic cough and was so thin you could count her ribs and she had no appetite. Nothing we gave her seemed to help her, until one day Mrs. Neibert asked me to try Vinol, and now she is hungry all the time, her cough is gone, she is stouter and has a more healthy color. I wish every mother who has a delicate child would try Vinol."—Mrs. ALBERT SLACK.

We guarantee Vinol, our delicious cod liver and iron tonic, to make delicate children healthy and strong.

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Druggists Oregon City, Oregon

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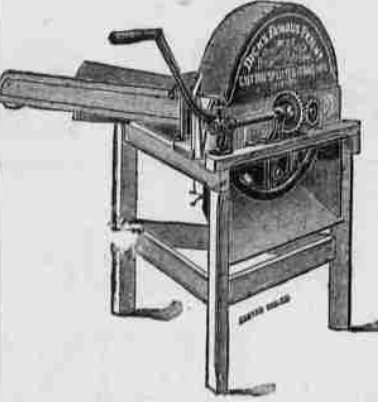
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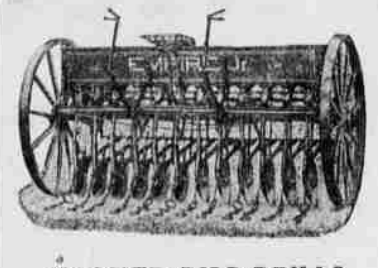
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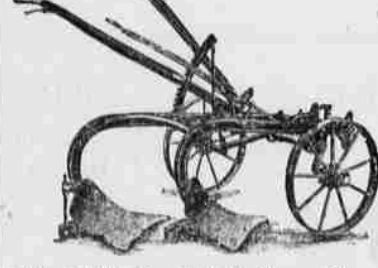
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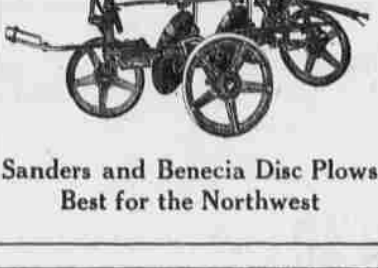
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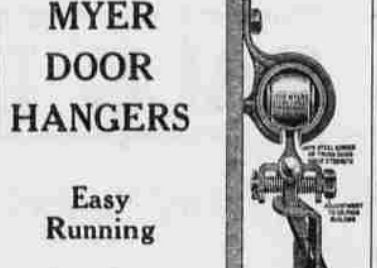
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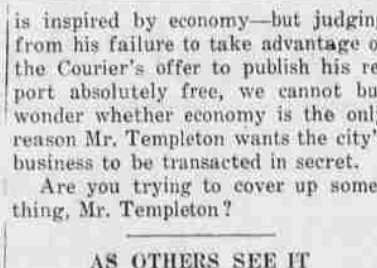
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has taught them the value of leadership and concerted effort. And finally, if there is anything that will breed in a boy's mind a supreme disgust for martinet, it is military training. In a school regiment the officers who are popular are those who treat their "soldiers" as equals, and the officers for whom nobody has any use are the dandies who spend hours polishing their swords, and who strut about like peacocks and imagine themselves "to be some peacocks," as the boys say.

Military training brings out the "boy spirit," but at the same time it curbs the tendency of boys to let their latent energies find relief in rowdiness. It teaches them control and dignity, it makes better men of them. Military training, as it is taught in the public schools, is simply a form of gymnastic drill, disguised under uniform, and is generally regarded as beneficial. Mollycoddles of both sexes who oppose it should study the records of public school boys in the states where the system prevails—and then they will wish that there could be military training for the girls as well.

## SIMPLE LOGIC

T. W. Sullivan, speaking for the committee of nine, told the city council last week that the way to figure a budget was to start in with the expenditures and then fix the levy sufficiently high to bring in an income that would pay for the budget. This bit

man ought to be made to justify this additional three mills.

Most of it, according to the budget, as passed by the council and the budget as outlined by Mr. Sullivan, will go into the street fund. Three mills for street work may not be very much by itself—but as Oregon City will get a goodly percentage of the road levy imposed upon it by the county, three percent additional for street work is "going some." Perhaps publicity regarding the details of street expenditures would justify this outlay—and perhaps it wouldn't. Publicity is the greatest friend of economy that has ever been discovered, but there appears to be an objection to publicity on the part of certain councilmen, who don't want city notices printed.

And as we said in the beginning, the way to fix a budget is to see how little needs be spent, not to start in with the intention of spending a ten-mill levy.

## WHY HIDE IT?

Two weeks ago he Courier offered Councilman Henry M. Templeton the use of its columns for the publication of a detailed report on the manner in which he and his councilmanic committee had spent the street funds in the county seat. Mr. Templeton, being a receptive candidate for the honors of the mayoralty, the Courier supposed he would jump at the chance to show what a fine and economical rec-

is inspired by economy—but judging from his failure to take advantage of the Courier's offer to publish his report absolutely free, we cannot but wonder whether economy is the only reason Mr. Templeton wants the city's business to be transacted in secret.

Are you trying to cover up something, Mr. Templeton?

## AS OTHERS SEE IT

It has been suggested that it would be just as well if Mr. G. C. Brownell would defer his attacks on the prohibition law until after it has been in operation long enough to test its strength, and then if his criticism is merited, possibly he can make suggestions that will be remedied instead of destructive. His speech recently delivered at Corvallis and reproduced in the Oregon City Morning Enterprise of Oct. 14, is a vicious attack on the law, directed in the main at the legislature because of the allowance per month for each home. We agree with Mr. Brownell in his contention that the law is not the kind of prohibitive measure the great majority of voters thought they were voting into existence last November, but it is the enforcement of this law that will be the test and not the expressed opposition made three months before the measure becomes operative. If Mr. Brownell will put as much energy into assisting the officers enforce the provisions of the law as he is in attacking its weak points he will do

## Better Yet

YOU HEAR IT SAID OF SOME MEN THAT THEIR WORD IS AS GOOD AS THEIR BOND, AND IT'S A FINE THING TO SAY OF ANY MAN.

But did you ever stop to think that no matter how good your word may be, there is something better? If you owe a bill at the store and pay it in cash and the merchant tries to collect the amount again, your word might be good that you had paid it. But suppose you had an account at the bank and paid by check. The cancelled check would speak louder than your own word, no matter how good your reputation. No getting around that. It pays to pay by check.

## The Bank of Oregon City

34 Years in Business